“I can get a gun.” André leaned forward. “Guys in my barracks have them. They’ve been stealing them from the guardhouse in anticipation of this day coming. In other towns, rumors circulate that the meisters running the factories are shooting the foreign workers before they have a chance to shoot them.”

A few nights ago, Léa heard gunshots and thought it could be the Soviet army, but the next day, when they didn’t arrive in town, she realized it was likely a dispute between a farmer and his workers. Order was breaking down. Standing still made them a target; movement provided safety. She turned to Rose. “Is there enough room in the car for all of us? I’ll put Katya on my lap.”

“The driver and Josef in the front; the three of us in the back.” Léa heard the edge in her sister’s voice and reached out to touch her shoulder.

“Is something wrong?”

“No, I’m fine. Let me take care of Katya. I’ll put her to sleep tonight—it will give you a much-needed break.” Rose cradled Katya, kissed her forehead and walked away. Rose’s love beamed over the baby, but why then had Léa heard a faint sob from her sister’s throat?

* * *

Sometime during the day, while Rose described their plan of escape and Josef stocked the few remaining supplies of food and water for the two patients he would leave behind, Léa made a decision. Tonight, their last night in Glashütte, while Rose had Katya, she would stay with Josef in the sick bay. It no longer mattered what Lagerführer Klein thought. They didn’t have to hide anymore. She wanted to be with him. She wanted to listen to the soft vibration of his voice, feeling the pressure of his hand on her waist. He brought sunshine into every room. When he wasn’t with her, she felt the world was in shadow and longed for his light. Tonight, they would make time for one another. Who knew how their journey would unfold tomorrow? But they had tonight. Josef had given so much of himself to others; now she wanted him all to herself, selfishly, maybe, just one night to keep him close. When she told him her plan, his eyes sparkled like rays of the sun, warming her heart.

They pulled two beds side by side. Léa settled next to him. She could